

Chicago Tribune



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MONDAY, AUGUST 11, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Barriers to higher education persist

College still pays off in Illinois, but study shows economic disparities

By Kate Armanini
Chicago Tribune

Tyshawn Allison dreamed of leaving Chicago for a prestigious out-of-state university.

But for most of high school, that dream felt out of reach. The 19-year-old had no idea how he'd afford rising tuition costs — and he doubted his grades would be enough for a scholarship. Only a handful of his friends from his Belmont Cragin school made it to college. Many dropped out.

"There were times in high school where I felt like a failure," said Allison.

It was his mom who first suggested community college. Two years later, Allison holds an associate degree in accounting, and will transfer to a four-year university without any debt.

"I wanted to end the circle of stereotypes," he said. "That's really what made me want to push myself."

Allison persisted against the odds.

Higher education remains the strongest pathway toward economic mobility. But students from low-income backgrounds and minority groups are still significantly less likely to pursue or complete a college degree, according to a July report from the Illinois Workforce and Education Research Collaborative, which studies the education-to-workforce pipeline.

Students from the lowest-income families were nearly three times more likely than their wealthier peers to drop out of college, the report said. More than half of students from low-income households listed "some college, no degree" as their highest level of education. They were also more likely to skip postsecondary education altogether.

While the report didn't directly explain why low-income students drop out, a large body of work points to financial constraints, limited support systems and a lack of resources as key factors, researchers said.

Some of it also is related to the types of postsecondary institutions low-income students attend. For-profit colleges, which tend to lead to greater debt, disproportion-

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STACEY WESCOTT/TRIBUNE

Bears take field for preseason opener

Team records its first exhibition tie since 1973 in a game at Soldier Field that, while it won't count in the standings, mattered to players down the depth chart who had an opportunity to show they belong, including quarterback Case Keenum, above. **Chicago Sports**

Packed fall lineup for humanities fest

Amid threats to arts and humanities funding nationwide, the Chicago Humanities Festival has scheduled weeks of talks, readings and performances in the heart of some of the most impacted local communities. **Arts & Living**



Sky co-owner and Operating Chairman Nadia Rawlinson watches the Sky play the Atlanta Dream at Wintrust Arena on Thursday. Rawlinson hopes to insulate Sky players from racist and misogynistic behavior. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

How Sky are looking to 'take control back'

Team addresses online abuse, harassment with cybersecurity measures

By Julia Poe
Chicago Tribune

Life online has changed for WNBA players.

Skyrocketing viewership, attention and investment also opened the floodgates to a deluge of racist, misogynistic and homophobic abuse. Over the last year, online behavior has spilled into real life, from fans throwing sex toys onto the court during games to stalkers attempting to meet star play-

ers. And the proliferation of sports gambling has added fuel to this fire of online abuse as disgruntled bettors take out their frustrations on athletes.

But players don't have the luxury of opting out — or logging off. With minimum salaries starting at \$66,000, WNBA players generate the bulk of their income through endorsement deals and partnerships that can revolve entirely around online campaigns. Athletes in women's

sports remain uniquely tied to their online profiles as a secondary income stream, creating a heightened vulnerability to online abuse and other harassment.

Chicago Sky Operating Chairman Nadia Rawlinson knows there isn't a singular solution to this problem. But as attention and abuse continue, Rawlinson hopes to insulate Sky players from this rapidly deteriorating online environment.

Midway through this season,

the Sky announced a partnership with Moonshot, a cybersecurity company that previously specialized in counterterrorism. The investment will utilize the company's proprietary technology to improve the Sky's cybersecurity measures by tracking and responding to the rapidly growing mess of online abuse, threats and harassment players face.

By nature, cybersecurity can

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Leah Tucker, 13, is hugged by Maria Pike, a gun violence survivor advocate, during a National Night Out event on Tuesday at Ogden Park in Chicago's Englewood neighborhood. **JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

'The small engine that can'

Chicago Survivors group faces funding strain as it operates in the aftermath of violence

By Caroline Kubzansky
Chicago Tribune

About an hour and a half after a fatal shooting Wednesday night, the sidewalk outside the emergency room was starting to get crowded around Jose Hernandez.

He stood quietly as more and more people drove up and began to pace outside the University of Chicago Medical Center. The

smell of cigarettes hung in the air. He scanned faces, looking for people he might recognize from the crime scene where a young man was found on a street in the Douglas neighborhood with a gunshot wound to the head.

Everyone Hernandez saw faced a long list of unknowns, about the killing itself and everything that would come next.

"People don't know what to expect," he said.

INSIDE

Thirteen people were shot, two fatally, in what appeared to be separate incidents on Chicago's West Side. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Hernandez is a crisis responder, whose job it is to connect with the families of homicide victims in the first blurry hours after a violent death and make sure they have help with the mountain of logistical and emotional needs that come

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Pritzker not ruling out a 2028 run for president

Governor calls Texas redistricting push illegal, hurls insults at Abbott

By Rick Pearson
Chicago Tribune

In his strongest public comments to date about his future political plans, Gov. JB Pritzker said Sunday he won't rule out seeking the Democratic nomination for president in 2028 even while he seeks reelection to a third term as Illinois' chief executive next year.

Pritzker, appearing on NBC's "Meet the Press," also contended that a Republican-backed remap of Texas' congressional districts — which sent more than 30 of that state's House Democrats to Illinois to block the move — would be "unconstitutional" for violating federal voting protections for racial and ethnic minorities.

Pritzker, who announced his bid for a third term as governor in June, has not explicitly said he is seeking the presidency. But he has had several speaking engagements in front of Democrats across the country, along with frequent national TV and podcast appearances. His role in hosting Texas House Democrats attempting to block the GOP remap has also raised his profile.

Asked by "Meet the Press" moderator Kristen Welker if he would rule out a presidential bid,

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